

JCOIN 2.0 Client-Level CDE REDCap Project Protocol

Create New Project in REDCap

- Click on **+ New Project** at top of REDCap page
- Enter project title and purpose
- For “Project creation option,” select **Empty project (blank slate)**
- Click **Create Project**
- Click **I Agree** (to the REDCap Use Agreement)

Upload Data Dictionary

- On the left side of the page, under “Project Home and Design,” click **Dictionary**
- Scroll down to Step 3 (“Upload your Data Dictionary file”)
 - *Do not change* either the “Format for min/max validation values...” (MM/DD/YYYY or YYYY-MM-DD) or the “CSV delimiter of data file” (Comma) selections. Use the default settings.
- Click **Choose file**
- Navigate to wherever you saved the client-level CDE csv file provided by the MAARC and click **Open**
- Click **Upload file**
- In the green box, you will see the message: “Your document was uploaded successfully and awaits your confirmation below”
- Scroll down to the blue box where you will see the message: “Are you ready to commit the changes to the project from the uploaded Data Dictionary?”
- Click **Commit changes**
- Congratulations! You will see the message: “Changes Made Successfully!”

IMPORTANT: Before using the project, a few local modifications and specifications must be made in order for the project to function properly. These are as follows.

Customizing Your Local Client-Level CDE REDCap Project

- (1) Set up project as a longitudinal project and define events (timepoints): REDCap allows for the use of an instrument across different timepoints in a longitudinal project, but this must be explicitly specified under Setup. REDCap refers to these timepoints as “events.”

[Note: **If you are only collecting data at one timepoint** (i.e., Baseline), you do not have to set up your project as a longitudinal project. However, you will need to remove branching/skip logic that refers to a Baseline event ID number. To do so, navigate to the **Demographics** instrument and scroll to the first field on the instrument, which contains event-specific branching logic. Click on the green branch to edit the field’s branching logic and delete the “[event-id]=’86473’” logic. Click “Update and Close Editor” and save these changes. If there is additional branching logic for a particular field, only delete the event-specific logic. You may now skip to #3 below.]

For projects collecting data at more than one timepoint:

- Set up longitudinal project:
 - On the left side of the page, under “Project Home and Design,” click **Setup**
 - Under “Main project settings,” click **Enable** next to “Use longitudinal data collection with defined events?”
- Define events (study timepoints):
 - Scroll down to “Define your events and designate instruments for them” and click on **Define My Events**
 - Click on the pencil icon next to “Event 1” and replace the Event Label with “Baseline”
 - Click **Save**
 - Continue adding events that mirror your data collection timepoints (e.g., under Event Label, enter “Three-Month Follow-Up,” then click **Add new event**, and so on for each data collection timepoint beyond Baseline). *If you do not yet know all of the additional timepoints for your study, you can add them later, but make sure to set up the Baseline timepoint now.*
- Assign instruments to events:
 - Once you have defined more than one event, click on the “Designate Instruments for My Events” tab at the top of the page.
 - You will see that all existing instruments are automatically assigned to the Baseline event. *Leave the Baseline instrument assignment as is, given that these are all required client-level instruments for JCOIN 2.0 studies.*
 - Click **Begin Editing** to “assign” instruments to the follow-up events in your project. If you do not know which instruments will be administered at follow-up timepoints, you can do this assignment later.

(2) Change event ID in Demographics instrument: Because some demographic questions (e.g., ethnicity) only need to be asked one time – at Baseline – the project is set up so that only certain demographic items will appear at follow-up timepoints. This is handled by including branching/skip logic on the Demographics instrument that specifically assigns these one-time-only questions to the Baseline event.

Each locally-defined event in REDCap has a unique ID number that must be specified in order for the branching logic to work here.

- To find the unique Event ID number associated with the Baseline event for your hub’s REDCap project, go to “Events” under Project Home and Design on the left side of the page.
- Scroll down to the list of events and note/copy the 5-digit event ID located in the Event ID column
- Go to “Designer” under Project Home and Design on the left side of the page
- Click on the Demographics instrument to open it and scroll down to the fields that should only appear at Baseline – for example, “D3. What is your race and/or ethnicity?”
- Click on the green branch icon at the top of the D3 field to edit the branching logic for this field
- Click on the **[event-id] = ‘86473’** in the box. This will open the editing box and you will replace the 86473 with your project’s unique 5-digit code for the Baseline event
 - *Change only the 5-digit number that appears in the box. Do not change the quotation marks, field name, or anything else.*
- Click Update and Close Editor
- You will be asked “Also edit branching logic for other fields?” which will change the Event ID number wherever it appears on the Demographic instrument.
 - Click “Yes, update 5 other fields”
- The Baseline-only demographic items will now only appear on the Demographic instrument at the Baseline timepoint.

(3) Adding and deleting fields from existing instruments

- Adding fields: You may add new fields to the existing instruments by navigating to the desired instrument via the Designer function. Once here, click on **Add Field** wherever you want the new field to appear.
- Deleting fields: You may delete existing fields with the “(OPTIONAL)” designation in the field label if you are not collecting that item; see IMPORTANT note below.
- Modifying fields:
 - Do not modify text, response options, or branching logic for any of the “OPTIONAL” items, unless you received explicit permission from NIDA to do so.
 - If you plan to collect information that is similar, but not identical, to the items in the current data dictionary, *add a new item rather than modifying an existing item* – unless you received explicit permission to modify the field.
 - Alternative versions of core items must be approved by NIDA. Alternative version of optional items are permissible, but must be communicated to MAARC; email Cami DeMarco at camilledemarco@bsd.uchicago.edu.
 - Note that some optional items are considered core items for hubs belonging to certain intercept groups, as communicated earlier.
 - If you are in doubt whether you may or may not make a specific modification to any of the existing items (core or optional), please reach out to Cami Demarco (camilledemarco@bsd.uchicago.edu) for clarification.

IMPORTANT: *Do not delete or modify any of the core items in this project, unless you have express written permission from NIDA to do so. For items containing wording options such as “...in the past 90 days OR in the 90 days prior to the current detention,” you may choose the wording that is aligned with your study’s purpose and delete the part of the phrase that is not relevant to your study. Otherwise, no modifications to wording or deletions of core CDEs are permissible.*

(4) Specifying default value for NIDA grant number

- Navigate to the Metadata instrument via Designer
- Click on the pencil icon for the M1 field to edit the field
- Click on the pink box for “Action Tags/Field Annotation”
- You will see “@DEFAULT=’12345’”
- Change the “12345” to your hub’s NIDA grant number. Do not change the @DEFAULT or the quotation marks.
- Click “Update and Close Editor” and then “Save.” This field will now be prefilled with your hub’s NIDA grant number on all data entry forms.

(5) Adding other instruments to the project: You may add hub-specific instruments to the project by navigating to the Designer page and clicking on **+Create** under Data Collection Instruments.

(6) Attaching missing data codes: JCOIN 2.0 uses a canonical set of missing data codes that will be attached to each question/item in the project. This functionality must be set up manually, as follows:

- Click on “Setup” under Project Home and Design on the left side of the page
- Scroll down to “Enable optional modules and customizations”
- Click on **Additional customizations**

- Scroll down to “Missing data codes: Set up your missing data codes for this project”
- In the box provided, enter the following exactly as it appears below, including the dot+letter before the code:
 - .a, Don't know
 - .b, Refused
 - .c, Left blank
 - .d, Legitimately skipped
 - .e, Not collected
 - .f, Missing in error
 - .g, Redacted
- Click **Save**
- Every item in the project now has a small “M” next to it (when in data entry mode), as shown by the red arrow below:

ETHNICITY/RACE: MATCH NIH REPORTING

D3. What is your race and/or ethnicity? (Select all that apply.)
* must provide value

  

- ☐ American Indian or Alaska Native
- ☐ Asian, Asian American, or Southeast Asia, including Chinese, Japanese, and others
- ☐ Black or African American
- ☐ Hispanic or Latino(a) or Latine/x
- ☐ Middle Eastern or North African
- ☐ Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander
- ☐ White or Caucasian
- ☐ Something else (specify)

- If the user clicks on the “M,” a menu appears that allows the user to select the reason for the missing data for that item:

ETHNICITY/RACE: MATCH NIH REPORTING

What is your race and/or ethnicity? (Select all that apply.)

 

- ☐ American Indian or Alaska Native
- ☐ Asian, Asian American, or Southeast Asia, including Chinese, Japanese, and others
- ☐ Black or African American
- ☐ Hispanic or Latino(a) or Latine/x
- ☐ Middle Eastern or North African
- ☐ Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander
- ☐ White or Caucasian
- ☐ Something else (specify)

Mark field as:

- [Clear value]
- Don't know (.a)
- Refused (.b)
- Left blank (.c)
- Legitimately skipped (.d)
- Not collected (.e)
- Missing in error (.f)
- Redacted (.g)

- Once selected, the missing data response appears in the field of the data entry form; e.g.:

ETHNICITY/RACE: MATCH NIH REPORTING	
D3. What is your race and/or ethnicity? (Select all that apply.) * must provide value	☐ American Indian or Alaska Native ☐ Asian, Asian American, or Southeast Asia, including Chinese, Japanese, and others ☐ Black or African American ☐ Hispanic or Latino(a) or Latine/x ☐ Middle Eastern or North African ☐ Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander ☐ White or Caucasian ☐ Something else (specify)
H M	
Refused (.b)	

IMPORTANT: All JCOIN 2.0 hubs must use this REDCap function to capture and code missing data in their CDE REDCap project.

- (7) Testing/adding new records to the project: Before entering data from actual participants, please test the functionality of your local REDCap project.
 - Click on “Add/Edit Records” under Data Collection on the left side of the project’s home page
 - Click on **+Add new record** to add a new record to the project. Unless otherwise specified (see Assigning ID numbers to participant records below), REDCap will open a new record, using the next sequential number in the project as the Record ID.
 - Begin data entry by clicking on the circle corresponding to the instrument you want to start entering data into

- (8) Assigning ID numbers to participant records: If you do not specify otherwise, REDCap will automatically number records sequentially as they come into the project with Record ID 1, 2, 3, and so on. You may, however, assign your own ID numbers to participant records as follows.
 - Click on “Setup” under Project Home and Design on the left side of the page.
 - Scroll down and click **Disable** next to “Auto-numbering for records” under “Enable optional modules and customizations.”
 - Now, when you go to “Add/Edit Records,” you will see a field where you can enter a new participant’s unique ID number and then Enter to open a new record for that participant.

- (9) Put project into production: After thoroughly testing the functionality of the REDCap project, you must now put the project into production.
 - Go to “Setup” and scroll down to the end of the page
 - Click on **Move project to production**
 - Read and agree to the Notice
 - You will be prompted to keep or delete existing data. Assuming all entered data to this point are test records, select “Delete all data in project.”
 - Click on “Yes, request admin to move to production status.”
 - You will receive an email notification once the project has been put into production, after which time you should not enter test data into the project. Only real/actual data should be entered into projects that are in production.

If you encounter difficulties with this process, please submit a technical assistance request at the JCOIN website: <https://www.jcoinctc.org/tta/>.